



ISSUE
12

BE THE Change

As citizens, we can help bring about the change we want by fulfilling our duties and keeping the pressure on the Government to deliver

The citizens' movement in the wake of the Mumbai attacks has been unprecedented in scale and involvement. People took to the streets, not just in Mumbai but across India, to protest against the government, demanding a change in the system, and pledging to make their voices heard and their actions count in the war on terror. The INDIA TODAY Group's Declare War on Terror campaign saw a massive 95,000 people from all walks of life pledging support. The anger and the outrage was palpable as well as the sense of fear and vulnerability. Most of them are sure of one thing: they want

change but are not sure how to achieve it, individually or collectively. They kept asking: Why was Mumbai 26/11 allowed to happen? What can be done to prevent it? What can the average citizens do?

There is considerable hope invested in the upsurge of patriotism, sense of nationalism and the desire to get involved. But it is worthwhile to channelise that public anger and outrage and think of ways to get involved as concerned citizens to catalyse the process of change. The War on Terror cannot be won unless we, the citizens, make it our own.

It would be naive on our part to expect the police to keep a

watch on every suspicious person or movement 24x7. Our responsibilities as concerned citizens have increased in these troubled times. Do not postpone the police verification as tomorrow may be too late. Similarly, with busy marketplaces becoming terror hotspots, increased vigilance will not only generate greater public awareness but also make you an involved citizen. You can make the difference by insisting that your residents welfare association beef up security and work out an emergency plan in case of an attack. You could also insist that your children's school keep a blueprint of its layouts and exits in case of emergency. You